Raising MoveInSync's Play Store rating: what to fix and in what order

Bottom line

The app's Play Store rating is already 4.6, and almost all of the gap to 5.0 comes from 1-star ratings. Three app problems explain most of why people give them. Fix these first, in this order:

1. **App stability and speed** (crashes, slow loading, blank screens): named in 17.9% of 1-2 star reviews, and 18.0% in the last 90 days.
2. **Booking and scheduling flow** (wrong dates, disabled Book button, bookings cancelled without warning): 11.0% overall, 13.7% in the last 90 days.
3. **Repeated logins and OTP failures**: 15.5% overall, falling to 11.2% in the last 90 days.

Before any of that, do two things this week: test the SOS button (three safety reviews say it fails) and start replying to 1-2 star reviews (only 4.8% get a reply today). Late cabs, routing and helpdesk problems are real but belong to operations (see "Escalate to operations").

What the rating really looks like

Observed. Google Play shows 4.6 from about 114,900 ratings. Here is how those ratings split, next to the 5,000 most recent written reviews I analysed (22 Jan 2025 to 11 Oct 2026):

Stars	All ratings (official)	Written reviews (sample)
1	6.4%	25.0%
2	0.7%	3.3%
3	1.1%	2.9%
4	6.3%	7.6%
5	85.5%	61.2%
Average	4.64	3.77

- The gap from 4.64 to 5.0 is 0.36 stars. About 70% of it comes from 1-star ratings alone.

- Written reviews are about 4 times more negative than all ratings, because unhappy people write more. So I used them only to learn **why** people give 1-2 stars, never to say how good the rating is.
- 1-2 star reviews are 28.3% of the written sample (1,413 reviews). All theme numbers below are shares of those 1,413.

Why people give 1-2 stars

Observed. I tagged each 1-2 star review by keywords (a review can have several themes). The "+/-" is statistical noise; themes closer than that are ties.

Theme	Share of 1-2 star reviews	Confidence in the tag	Owner
App crash / bug / slow	17.9% (+/-2.0)	Good	Android/iOS engineering
Login / OTP / registration	15.5% (+/-1.9)	Very good	Auth / backend
Booking fails / schedule confusion	11.0% (+/-1.6)	Moderate	Product + engineering
UI/UX and forced updates	9.4% (+/-1.5)	Moderate	Product / design
Driver behaviour	8.3% (+/-1.4)	Low (loose keywords)	Operations
Live tracking / GPS / ETA	8.1% (+/-1.4)	Good	Engineering + maps
Support not resolved	7.2% (+/-1.3)	Good	Operations
Late / no-show cab	7.1% (+/-1.3)	Fair	Operations
Routing / pickup time changes	6.2% (+/-1.3)	Fair	Operations
In-app calling / mic permission	5.7% (+/-1.2)	Low	Engineering
Trip rating feature	3.7% (+/-1.0)	Fair	Product
Notifications / SMS	3.2% (+/-0.9)	Fair	Engineering
Address / home location	1.4% (+/-0.6)	Fair	Product
Safety	1.3% (+/-0.6)	Fair	Safety + engineering

Reading the table. Crashes/slowness and login are close to a tie at the top. Together with booking and UI, app-side problems are the largest block. When I read 50 low-star reviews by hand, about 14% were too vague to classify, and only 2 of 50 were about late cabs and none about safety. Late cabs and safety are small in count, but safety is handled separately below because of severity.

Fix first: three app problems

1. App stability and speed (17.9%)

- **Observed:** Of 253 reviews: 57 mention slow or long loading, 33 crashes or the app closing by itself, 8 blank/white screens, 8 QR scan problems. One review names an Android 17 Pixel 8 crash on open.
- **Hypothesis (not proven):** Slow loading on poor networks and a crash on newest Android versions. Reviews carry no device or OS data, so this cannot be confirmed from them.
- **Fix:** Pull Android vitals (crash rate, ANR rate, by app version, Android version, device) from Play Console. Fix the top 3 crash clusters. Add loading states and caching for the booking and route screens.
- **Owner:** Mobile engineering lead.
- **Metric:** crash-free users above 99.5%; share of 1-2 star reviews mentioning crash/slow below 12%.
- **Tomorrow:** Open Play Console, Quality, Android vitals; export the top crash clusters of the last 30 days and assign owners.

2. Booking and scheduling flow (11.0%)

- **Observed:** Of 156 reviews: 59 are about dates, times or schedule display, 28 cannot book (e.g. "Book Now" disabled with all fields filled), 19 about bookings cancelled, waitlisted or marked no-show. Single reviews report a Sunday booking auto-dated Tuesday, no AM/PM on the booking card, only 2-3 days visible, and booking a shuttle becoming two steps after an update.
- **Hypothesis:** The date and time logic and the button's enabled state have edge-case bugs, and the UI hides information that users need to confirm a booking.
- **Fix:** Reproduce the disabled Book button and the weekend date rollover. Add AM/PM or 24-hour time on the booking card. Show the full booking window. Warn before and explain after any auto-cancel.
- **Owner:** Product manager for booking, plus one engineer.
- **Metric:** booking completion rate; share of 1-2 star reviews about booking below 7%.

- **Tomorrow:** Test the booking flow on a Sunday and on a weekday evening with a real account; log each wrong date or disabled state as a ticket.

3. Repeated logins and OTP failures (15.5%)

- **Observed:** Of 219 reviews: 95 say they are asked to log in or enter an OTP again and again, 77 say the OTP did not arrive or was rejected, 19 cannot log in at all. One review says the OTP is requested at every app open, even within 5 minutes. This theme is the best-validated one (10 of 10 held-out checks correct). Its share fell from 16.2% to 11.2% in the last 90 days, a change larger than noise, so something may already have improved.
- **Hypothesis:** Short session or token expiry, and an OTP provider that is slow or unreliable on some networks.
- **Fix:** Extend session lifetime with refresh tokens. Check OTP delivery success and delay by provider. Offer a retry or alternate channel.
- **Owner:** Authentication / backend lead.
- **Metric:** OTP delivery success rate and median delay; logins per user per week.
- **Tomorrow:** Pull the auth logs for the last 7 days: how often is OTP re-requested within one hour of a previous login, and what is OTP delivery success.

Ordering is a judgement call. By share, login is nearly tied with stability. I put stability first because it is the biggest theme and in the last 90 days it is higher than login; login comes third because its trend is improving.

Do this week

Test the SOS button. Three of the 18 safety-tagged reviews say SOS does not work (one: "SOS does not work if pressed during accident time"). The count is small but the severity is high. Press it on iOS and Android with a test account and confirm it reaches the control room. Owner: safety lead and mobile engineering.

Reply to 1-2 star reviews. Today only 4.8% of 1-2 star reviews (68 of 1,413) get a reply, replies take a median 1.4 days, and many are generic ("We've forwarded your feedback to our developers"). Replying costs no engineering time. Write short replies that name the fix or the next step, and reply within 2 days. Owner: product or support lead. Metric: reply rate on 1-2 star reviews above 50%, and ratings changed after a reply (Play lets users edit their rating).

Escalate to operations

These cause real 1-2 star ratings but a software release will not fix them. Send them to the operations team with the numbers.

- **Late cabs (7.1%) and routing / pickup time changes (6.2%).** Routing rose by 6 points in June and August 2026.
- **Helpdesk unreachable.** Of 56 low-star reviews that mention the helpdesk or transport team, 22 say nobody answers.
- **No-show disputes (39 reviews).** In the ones I read, employees say they were marked no-show unfairly and the app gives no way to dispute it. This one has an app-side fix: add a "dispute this no-show" button. Owner: operations with product.
- **Driver behaviour (8.3%).** The keywords for this theme were loose (4 of 10 held-out checks correct), so treat the number as an upper bound.

What the weak months suggest

Observed, not proven to be causes. In the five weakest months, one or two themes were above their usual share. This is an association with a release, not evidence the release caused it.

Month	Avg stars	Themes above usual	Most common version
Feb 2025	3.46	Login +18 pts, crash +11 pts	11.5.17
Sep 2025	3.52	Trip rating feature +10 pts	12.4
Jun 2026	3.56	Routing +6, tracking +5	12.13.1
Jun 2025	3.56	Login +9	12.1 / 12.1.2
Aug 2026	3.65	Routing +6	12.17.0

No single version stands out as the worst (monthly averages range 3.57 to 3.71 against 3.77 overall). One Sep 2025 review says the new "rate previous ride" pop-up blocks access to route details when it does not load. **Suggested check:** compare crash and login metrics for versions 11.5.17, 12.1.x and 12.4 against their neighbours, and look at the release notes for what changed. Month-to-month averages move by about 0.1 from noise alone, so small dips mean little.

How to answer "How are our Play Store ratings?" every time

The analysis is one script that anyone can re-run (code and README in the project repository). Run `python playstore_analyzer.py` and it:

1. Downloads the latest written reviews and the official score and star counts.
2. Tags each review by theme and shows each theme's share, with the owner.
3. Writes a short report (`report.md`), two charts, and a validation sample.
4. Adds one row to `history.csv` , so the trend builds up run by run.

Every answer should say first the official rating and the 1-star share, and second which themes moved beyond noise since the last run. Run it monthly and after each release. **Next improvement (not yet built):** save the official star counts at every run, so the real mix of new ratings can be measured without the written-review bias.

Assumptions, validation and limits

- **Written reviews are not all ratings.** Only a minority of raters write text, and they skew negative. Theme shares describe 1-2 star reviewers who wrote something, not every unhappy user. The sample is the latest 5,000 written reviews, while the official counts are all-time.
- **Mentions are not causes.** A keyword means the review mentions a topic. It does not prove that topic produced the rating, and a rating lift from any fix is a ranking aid, not a forecast.
- **Validation.** I hand-labelled 50 low-star reviews. Script coverage for specific complaints was 93-95% after fixes, but the keywords were tuned on those same 50, so that figure is optimistic. On a fresh set of 10 reviews per theme I judged: login 10/10, tracking 8/10, crash 7/10 (10/10 if counted as general malfunction), booking 7/10, UI 6/10, calling 5/10, driver 4/10. Samples this small are rough. Treat login, crash, tracking and booking as reliable; UI, calling and driver as soft.
- **Known gaps.** About 14% of low-star reviews are too vague to classify. Non-English reviews (Hinglish, Tagalog) are missed by the keywords. Some reviews come from drivers or concern parking or shuttle modules.
- **Not available in reviews:** device, Android version, network, and what changed in each release. Every item under "Hypothesis" needs Play Console data (Android vitals, release notes) and auth logs to confirm.